
BORN 1936, AMERICAN

One of the world's leading Minimalist composers, Reich had a rich, varied musical upbringing and education. His mother was a Broadway lyricist and he became an accomplished jazz drummer when he was in his teens, before studying more conventionally at the prestigious Juilliard School in New York and with the composer Luciano Berio at Mills College in California. Reich's work typically involves the repetition and subtle elaboration of short phrases. Reich began by working with tape machines playing recorded loops that gradually moved out of synchronization, and progressed to more conventional instruments, sometimes incorporating recorded speech, as in *Different Trains*, perhaps his most acclaimed work. This three-movement piece features a string quartet blended with recordings of train noises and voices speaking about trains, including ones that carried victims to concentration camps during the Holocaust (part of Reich's exploration of his Jewish heritage). He has often collaborated with his wife, video artist Beryl Korot.

KEY WORKS: *Drumming*, 1971; *Different Trains*, 1988; *The Cave* (multimedia opera), 1993; *Three Tales* (video opera), 2002